

# Zandaley “Zan” Mignon Bothma

**Learning Designer · Digital Learning Content · Higher Education and Training**

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## PROFILE

Early-career learning designer completing a Postgraduate Diploma in Instructional Design, with 8 years of teaching experience in Vietnam, China (remote) and South Africa, including two short academic literacy roles at the University of the Free State. In my teaching I have regularly created and adapted lesson materials, and through my diploma I have designed curriculum plans, learning outcomes, assessments and a job aid, mostly as course projects. My current diploma research looks at learning design in higher education.

A journalism degree trained me to write and edit with close attention to grammar, structure and clarity, and to research quickly and meet deadlines. I’m competent in D2L Brightspace and TalentLMS and pick up new technology quickly and on my own. I’m looking for a first learning design role where I can work with subject experts and grow my experience in higher education.

## KEY STRENGTHS

**Learning content development**
Weekly lesson materials as a teacher; curriculum plans, learning outcomes and assessment plans through diploma projects.

**Writing and editing**
Editing for grammar, structure and clarity (journalism training); feedback on university students’ academic writing.

**LMS and digital delivery**
Competent in D2L Brightspace and TalentLMS; teach regularly on ClassIn; quick to learn new platforms.

**Quality and alignment**
Applying constructive alignment, Bloom’s Digital Taxonomy and UDL in diploma work; checking content against outcomes and sources.

**Collaboration**
Co-designed a job aid with a new employee; worked with school coordinators across several schools in Hanoi.

**Project and content management**
Meeting deadlines across diploma projects alongside part-time teaching; documenting decisions and AI use in project logs.

**Learning technology**
Interested in new learning tools; critical, transparent use of AI for research and drafting.

## INSTRUCTIONAL DESIGN PROJECTS

*Postgraduate Diploma in Instructional Design, Emeris / Vega, 2026 to present*

- **Higher education research proposal:** Wrote a research proposal (not yet carried out) on how instructional designers in higher education could see how students work with AI, including a literature review table, persona, planning document and poster. Checked AI-drafted content line by line against the sources.
- **AI-integrated learning platform (original concept):** Designed a concept for an AI-integrated learning platform that makes student reflection visible, including wireframes and a working prototype.
- **Adult literacy curriculum and assessment plan (conceptual):** Designed a six-session curriculum and assessment plan for a hypothetical group of rural Zambian women. Used AI to draft the first learning outcomes and session table, then revised them using constructive alignment and the course literature.
- **Facilitator orientation programme (online):** Planned (as a course project) an online programme to help facilitators adopt a new learning platform, with learner personas, outcomes, a storyboard and a wireframe.
- **Workplace onboarding job aid:** Worked with a new employee at a natural stone wholesaler to capture her role in a job aid. The process showed the company that it needed a formal SOP for the role, which it then created due to my input.
- **Reflective journal website:** Designed and built an LMS-style multimodal journal on GitHub Pages (zandaleyid.github.io/journal), teaching myself to code it with AI assistance.

## TEACHING AND LEARNING EXPERIENCE

**Online English Teacher** 2025 – present
*Nice Tutor / Nice Kid, China (remote via ClassIn)*

- Deliver live one-on-one online lessons to learners aged 5 to 16, working remotely from South Africa across time zones.

**Secondary English Teacher** 2023 – 2025
*Ly Thai To Secondary School, Language Link Vietnam (Schools Link), Hanoi*

- Produced a full set of weekly learning materials for Grade 6 English and English Literature, including slides, worksheets and interactive games built with multimedia and AI tools.
- **Awarded Teacher of the Year, Semester 1, 2024–2025**; above-standard ratings in all formal observations and performance reviews.

**Secondary English Teacher** 2022 – 2023
*Marie Curie Secondary School, Language Link Vietnam (Schools Link), Hanoi*

- Adapted National Geographic Impact 1 and 2 for Grades 6 and 7, creating original interactive materials and differentiating for mixed-ability classes.

**Kindergarten and Primary ESL Teacher** 2019 – 2022
*Various public schools, Language Link Vietnam (Schools Elite and Schools Link), Hanoi*

- Taught kindergarten and Grades 1 to 5 across multiple schools; above-standard ratings for the 2021–2022 final observation and overall performance.

**Online ESL Teacher** 2020
*Landi English, online*

- Taught learners aged 3 to 16 using structured lesson frameworks; tracked weekly progress and reported to parents.

**Academic Literacy Facilitator** 2018
*Unit for Language Development, University of the Free State, South Africa*

- Designed and delivered weekly academic literacy and business English lessons for first-year economics students.

**Academic Writing Consultant** 2017 – 2018
*Centre for Teaching and Learning, University of the Free State, South Africa*

- Gave students targeted feedback to develop the structure, clarity and referencing of their academic writing.

## EDUCATION AND QUALIFICATIONS

**Postgraduate Diploma in Instructional Design** 2026 – present
*Emeris / Vega (The Independent Institute of Education), South Africa*

- Modules: Instructional Design and Innovation · Approaches to Teaching and Learning in Africa · Multimodal Content for Online Learning · Instructional Design Research
- 80% or above in every formative and summative assessment to date.

**Bachelor of Journalism (BJourn)** 2012 – 2015
*Rhodes University, Grahamstown, South Africa*

- Specialisations: Photojournalism (2014), Digital Media (2015).

**TEFL/TESOL Certificate (150 hours)** 2017
*Global Language Training, online*

## TOOLS AND TECHNOLOGY

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|---|---|
| **Learning management systems** | D2L Brightspace, TalentLMS |
| **Online classrooms** | ClassIn, Zoom |
| **Design and content** | Canva, Whimsical (wireframes), storyboarding |
| **Web and publishing** | GitHub Pages |
| **AI tools** | Claude, Notebook Gemini, Grammarly (research, drafting and editing, with transparent disclosure) |
| **Productivity** | Microsoft Office, Google Workspace |

## REFERENCES

**Himani Ochani**
Academic Coordinator, Language Link Vietnam · himani.ochani@languagelink.vn

**Mario Landman**
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